

Intrinsically Recursive Coalgebras

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- This talk:
 - Motivation for Divide-and-Conquer Algorithms, categorically
 - How proving partial correctness sets the stage for expressing...
 - our novel categorical criterion for termination of such algorithms!

Structure

- 1 Divide and Conquer
- 2 Example: QuickSort
- 3 WDYM *recursive positions?* WDYM *smaller?*
- 4 Application to QuickSort
- 5 Current & Future Work
- 6 Conclusion

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- A D&C algorithm can be split into the following steps:
 - *Divide* input into “smaller”¹ inputs;
 - Recursively apply the algorithm to them;
 - *Combine* to compute the result.

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- Algorithms can differ in which step does the “heavy lifting”
- Quicksort: Main logic in the *divide* step: partition elements around the pivot. Combine step: concatenation.
- Mergesort: Business end is the *combine* step: zipping two ordered lists into one. Divide step: Splitting the list in half.

D&CAs as Coalgebra-to-Algebra Morphisms

$$\begin{array}{ccc} FI & \xrightarrow{Fh} & FO \\ \uparrow c & & \downarrow a \\ I & \dashrightarrow h & O \end{array}$$

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- *Coalgebra* c : Divide input up into smaller inputs, the distribution of which is given by a functor F ;
- Fh : Apply h recursively under F ;
- *Algebra* a : Combine an F -structure of the results of recursive calls to obtain the output.

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- A coalgebra c is called *recursive* if, for every algebra a , it admits a unique solution to the equation²

$$h = c; Fh; a$$

²sometimes called the “hylo” or *hylomorphism* equation

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- NB: In a language permitting general recursion, the above may be read as a *definition*.

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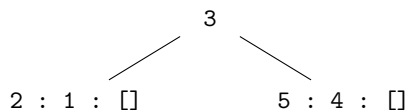
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- We therefore focus on that step from now.
- partition: $\text{List}A \rightarrow 1 + \text{List}A \times A \times \text{List}A \dots$
- $\dots \Rightarrow$ Functor F is: $F X = 1 + X \times A \times X$

Example: Growing a BST with partition

2 : 5 : 4 : 1 : 3 : []

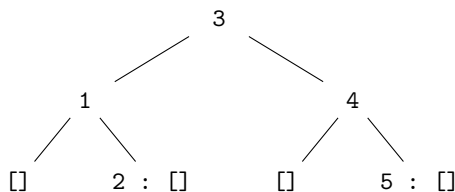
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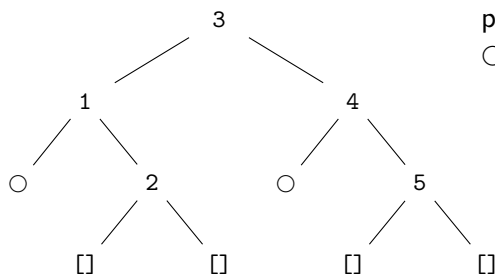
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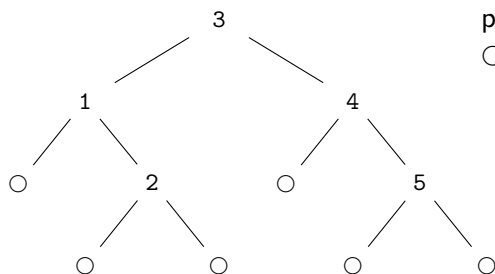
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Partial Correctness of QuickSort

- Orderedness: The elements to the left/right of the pivot in the $\text{List } A \times (p : A) \times \text{List } A$ case are smaller/greater than p
- Element-preservation: $\text{partition}(xs)$ and xs have the same multiset of elements.
- Working in the setting of data with mappings to the multiset $(\mathcal{B}A)$ of their elements allows us to express both these properties!
- We focus on the element-preservation property here, as that is relevant for termination.

Sliced Partition

- Redefine partition in the slice category $\mathbf{Set}/\mathcal{B}A$
- We can define lift F to $\bar{F}$ as:

$$\bar{F} \begin{pmatrix} X \\ f \end{pmatrix} := \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ \emptyset \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} \{(l, p, r) \in X \times A \times X\} \\ f(l) \uplus \{p\} \uplus f(r) \end{pmatrix}$$

- Note: The multiset indices of the recursive positions are smaller than the outer index: $|f(l)|, |f(r)| < |f(l) \uplus \{p\} \uplus f(r)|$.

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Formalizing “the indices of the recursive positions are smaller than the outer index”

Notation

Fix a well order $(W, <)$. For $i \in W$, we denote by $< i := \{j \in W \mid j < i\}$ the set of indices strictly smaller than i (the *downset* of i). We have two projection functors, *restriction* and *evaluation*:

$$\begin{array}{ll} -|_{<i} : \mathcal{C}^W \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^{<i} & \text{ev}_i : \mathcal{C}^W \rightarrow \mathcal{C} \\ X|_{<i} := (X_j)_{j \in <i} & \text{ev}_i X := X_i \end{array}$$

Introducing: Well Founded Functors

- Intuition: “The i th output of the functor $F: \mathcal{C}^W \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^W$ is fully determined by its inputs with indices $j < i$.”

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- “ $F: \mathcal{C}^{j \in W} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^{i \in W}$ is morally equivalent to a family $(F_{<i}: \mathcal{C}^{j < i} \rightarrow \mathcal{C})_{i \in W}$ ”

Introducing: Well Founded Functors

Definition (Well-Founded Functor)

A functor $F: \mathcal{C}^W \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^W$ is *well-founded* if for every $i \in W$, the composition $\text{ev}_i \cdot F: \mathcal{C}^W \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ factors through the restriction $|_{<i}: \mathcal{C}^W \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^{<i}$, that is, there exists a functor $F_{<i}$ such that the diagram below commutes up to natural isomorphism:

$$\forall i \in W: \quad \begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C}^W & \xrightarrow{F} & \mathcal{C}^W \\ \downarrow |_{<i} & \cong & \downarrow \text{ev}_i \\ \mathcal{C}^{<i} & \xrightarrow{\exists F_{<i}} & \mathcal{C} \end{array}$$

Proving WFness of a functor

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \mathcal{C}^W & \xrightarrow{F} & \mathcal{C}^W \\
 \downarrow -|_{<i} & \cong & \downarrow \text{ev}_i \\
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 \end{array}$$

- We define a canonical way to turn any functor F into a family $F_{<i} : (\mathcal{C}^{<i} \rightarrow \mathcal{C})_{i \in W}$, for which we obtain a projection $\varepsilon_F X i : F_{<i}(X|_{<i})i \rightarrow FXi$.

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- Client code of the library then consists of defining an inclusion $\varepsilon_F^{-1} Xi : FXi \rightarrow F_{<i}(X|_{<i})i$ which is an inverse to this.
- Next: How we use these parts to solve our original goal of proving recursivity for coalgebras for F

Diagrammatically

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 (F_{<i} C \mid_{<i})_i & \xrightarrow{(F_{<i} h \mid_{<i})_i} & (F_{<i} D \mid_{<i})_i \\
 \begin{array}{c} \textcolor{red}{\uparrow} \epsilon_i^{-1} \\ FC_i \end{array} & \xrightarrow{Fh_i} & \begin{array}{c} \downarrow \epsilon_i \\ FD_i \end{array} \\
 \begin{array}{c} \uparrow c_i \\ C_i \end{array} & \xrightarrow{h_i} & \begin{array}{c} \downarrow a_i \\ D_i \end{array}
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- Next: How we define $F_{<i}$

Wellfoundedification

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 \mathcal{C}^{<i} & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \mathcal{C} \\
 \downarrow J_{<i} & & \uparrow \text{ev}_i \\
 \mathcal{C}^W & \xrightarrow{F} & \mathcal{C}^W
 \end{array}$$

Definition (Inclusion Functor $J_{<}$)

$$(J_{<i}X)_j: \mathcal{C}^{<i} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^W$$

$$(J_{<i}X)_j := \begin{cases} X_j & \text{if } j < i, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

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- N.B.: Need decidability of $<?$ to define $J_{<i}$. Then, to prove inhabitation of $(J_{<i}X)_j$, one need prove $j <? i$ evaluate to $\top$.
- We avoid this by specializing $\mathcal{C}$ to Set , and using *copartial elements*:

$$(J_{<i}X)_j: \text{Set}^{<i} \rightarrow \text{Set}^W \quad (J_{<i}X)_j := \{x \mid j < i, x \in X_j\}$$

Mechanization

$< : A \rightarrow \text{Type} \text{ -- downset}$

$< i = \Sigma [j \in A] (j < i)$

-- restriction

$_ |< _ : (A \rightarrow \text{Type}) \rightarrow (i : A) \rightarrow ((< i) \rightarrow \text{Type})$

$(X |< i) (j, _pf) = X j$

$\text{-- inclusion: copartial element formulation}$

$J< : (i : A) \rightarrow ((< i) \rightarrow \text{Type}) \rightarrow (A \rightarrow \text{Type})$

$J< i X j = \Sigma [pf \in j < i] X (j, pf)$

$\text{-- truncation: restriction, then inclusion: } _ |<; J< \approx T$

$T : (i : A) \rightarrow (A \rightarrow \text{Type}) \rightarrow (A \rightarrow \text{Type})$

$T i X j = (j < i) \times X j \text{ -- "annotate with pfs } j < i"$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 \mathcal{C}^W & \xrightarrow{-|< i} & \mathcal{C}^{< i} & \xrightarrow{J_{< i}} & \mathcal{C}^W \\
 \downarrow F & \cong & \downarrow F_{< i} & & \downarrow F \\
 \mathcal{C}^W & \xrightarrow{\text{ev}_i} & \mathcal{C} & \xleftarrow{\text{ev}_i} & \mathcal{C}^W
 \end{array}$$

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Going Back to Definition-Time with Inversion

```

data T (X : BA → Type) : BA → Type where
  leaf : T X []
  _||[_]_ : {i_l i_r : BA} → (u : X i_l) → (p : A) →
    (v : X i_r) → T X (p :: i_l ++ i_r)
pattern _^_||[_]_ ^_ u i_l p v i_r = _||[_]_ {i_l} {i_r} u p v

```

$$T\text{-}\epsilon^{-1} : \{X : BA \rightarrow \text{Type}\} \rightarrow (i : BA) \rightarrow T\ X\ i \rightarrow T\ (J < i\ (X\ |< i))\ i$$

$$T\text{-}\epsilon^{-1} . [] \quad \text{leaf} \quad = \text{leaf}$$

$$T\text{-}\epsilon^{-1} . (p :: i_l ++ i_r)\ (u \wedge i_l\ ||\ p\ ||\ v \wedge i_r) =$$

$$((i_l < i, u)\ ||\ p\ ||\ (i_r < i, v)) \text{ where } i_l < i : (i_l <_{\#} p :: i_l ++ i_r) ; i_r < i : (i_r <_{\#} p :: i_l ++ i_r)$$

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$$\mathsf{T}\text{-}\epsilon^{-1} : \{X : \mathcal{B}A \rightarrow \mathsf{Type}\} \rightarrow (i : \mathcal{B}A) \rightarrow \mathsf{T} X i \rightarrow \mathsf{T} (\mathsf{J} < i (X | < i)) i$$

(1) Pattern match

$T_{-\epsilon^{-1}}.[]$ **leaf** $\leftarrow$ $\mid$ = **leaf**

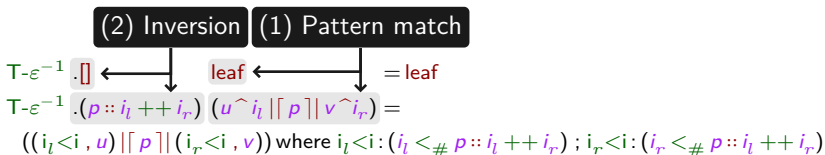
$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbf{T}_{-\varepsilon^{-1}}.(p :: i_l ++ i_r) \ (u \hat{=} i_l \parallel [p] \parallel v \hat{=} i_r) = \\ & ((i_l < i, u) \parallel [p] \parallel (i_r < i, v)) \text{ where } i_l < i : (i_l <_{\#} p :: i_l ++ i_r) ; i_r < i : (i_r <_{\#} p :: i_l ++ i_r) \end{aligned}$$

- 1** Pattern match on the value of type $\top \times X_i$;

Going Back to Definition-Time with Inversion

data $\mathbf{T} (X : \mathcal{B} A \rightarrow \mathbf{Type}) : \mathcal{B} A \rightarrow \mathbf{Type}$ where
 $\mathbf{leaf} : \mathbf{T} X []$
 $_||_ : \{i_l i_r : \mathcal{B} A\} \rightarrow (u : X i_l) \rightarrow (p : A) \rightarrow$
 $(v : X i_r) \rightarrow \mathbf{T} X (p :: i_l ++ i_r)$
 pattern $_^\wedge_||_^\wedge_ u i_l p v i_r = _||_ \{i_l\} \{i_r\} u p v$

$\mathbf{T}\text{-}\epsilon^{-1} : \{X : \mathcal{B} A \rightarrow \mathbf{Type}\} \rightarrow (i : \mathcal{B} A) \rightarrow \mathbf{T} X i \rightarrow \mathbf{T} (J < i (X |< i)) i$

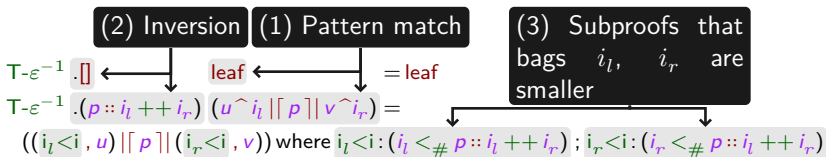


- 1 Pattern match on the value of type $\mathbf{T} X i$;
- 2 by *inversion* (Dybjer '94), this will refine the original index (seen here as *dot patterns*);

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data $T (X : \mathcal{B} A \rightarrow \text{Type}) : \mathcal{B} A \rightarrow \text{Type}$ where
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- 1 Pattern match on the value of type $T X i$;
- 2 by *inversion* (Dybjer '94), this will refine the original index (seen here as *dot patterns*);
- 3 prove that the indices in the functorial positions are smaller than the original, now refined, outer index.

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- 6 Conclusion

Inclusion-restriction adjunction

For our original $(J_{<i}X)_j: \mathcal{C}^{<i} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^W$ we have:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C}^{<i} & \xrightarrow{J_{<i}} & \mathcal{C}^W \\ & \perp & \\ & \xleftarrow{-|_{<i}} & \end{array}$$

However, for $J_{<}$, only the counit can be defined. It turns out that our formalization dualizes to a *partial element* formulation.

$$J_{<} J'_{<} : (i : A) \rightarrow ((i <) \rightarrow \text{Type}) \rightarrow (A \rightarrow \text{Type})$$

$$J'_{<} i X j = \forall (pf : j < i) \rightarrow X(j, pf)$$

$$J_{<} i X j = \Sigma[pf \in j < i] X(j, pf)$$

Dually for $J'_{<}$ only the unit can be defined. Intuition: partial element defer checking totality to *elimination*; copartial elements must be shown total at introduction.

Future Work

- Explore the (co)partial element connection further to un-specialize from Set
- Develop a variant of our technique for an entirely non-indexed (extrinsic) setting

Structure

- 1 Divide and Conquer
- 2 Example: QuickSort
- 3 WDYM *recursive positions?* WDYM *smaller?*
- 4 Application to QuickSort
- 5 Current & Future Work
- 6 Conclusion**

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- General equational definitions, with the possibility to use facilities for generic programming for the remaining boilerplate

$$a\ i \circ F_1\ (\text{iuncurry}\ i\ IH)\ i \circ Fwf\ i \circ c\ i$$

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- More applications & corollaries in our PLDI paper (formalized: correct GCD, CYK)

Contact

Our PLDI '26 paper:



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